



HNDIT4042: Professional World



Week1

Course Information

Semester	3	Credits	3
For Full-time	Hours/Week	Lecture	2
		Tutorial	2
For Part-time		Lecture	2
		Tutorial	1
GPA/NGPA	GPA	Type	Compulsory



Outline Syllabus

1. Professionalism - Profession, Professional Institutions/Bodies
2. Professionalism - Professional Institutions/Bodies - Code of Conduct
3. Professional Skills for an IT professional - Framework for IT
4. Professional Skills for an IT professional - SFIA and SFIA Plus
5. Professional Skills for an IT professional - Role models
6. Ethics - Ethical foundations and theories
7. Ethics - Evaluating Ethical Dilemmas
8. Law - Legal foundations and theories
9. Law - IT related laws of Sri Lanka
10. Disparity - SDG
11. Disparity - Digital Divide
12. Role of the stakeholders - Government responsibilities, Citizen responsibilities
13. Role of the stakeholders - Corporate responsibilities
14. Future - Building up a career
15. Future - Plan for becoming an effective IT professional



The Concept of Professionalism

Professionalism is defined by formal qualifications, adherence to ethical and technical standards, legal recognition, accountability to regulatory bodies, and a commitment to public interest.



The concept of Professionalism in this context can be understood through several key themes

- **Legal Recognition and Regulation** – Professionalism involves **formal recognition by the state or relevant governing bodies**. This is achieved through **reservation of title** (restricting the use of a professional title to qualified individuals) and **reservation of function** (limiting specific professional activities to those with appropriate credentials).
- **Competency and Qualification** – A core aspect of professionalism is **ensuring that only individuals with the necessary education, training, and expertise can practice within a field**. Examples such as architects, accountants, veterinary surgeons, and engineers who must meet specific standards to protect public safety and interest.



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- **Ethical Responsibility and Public Interest** – Professionalism is not just about qualifications but also about **adhering to ethical standards that prioritize public welfare**. The regulation of certain professions aims to prevent harm caused by unqualified practitioners, whether in medicine, engineering, or software development.
- **Accountability and Regulatory Bodies** – Professionalism requires oversight by regulatory **authorities that enforce standards, discipline members for misconduct, and uphold ethical codes**.
- **Challenges and Debates in Professionalism** – There are **controversies related to professional monopolies, enforcement difficulties, and resistance to regulation**. For instance, while software engineering has been suggested for regulation, challenges such as defining critical systems and ensuring a sufficient workforce make full enforcement impractical.



Concept of Profession

- Professional footballers are footballers who make their living from the game.
- Professional employees are employees of a certain status, who are **expected**, within limits, **to put the interests of the organization they work for above their own convenience**.
- To describe someone as a real professional implies that they can be relied on to carry out their work competently and conscientiously regardless of the circumstances.
- A professional piece of work means a piece of work that meets established standards of quality.
- Occupations that would commonly be described as professions – **lawyers, doctors, dentists, accountants, veterinary surgeons, architects** and so on.



There are a number of **characteristics** that most of them have in common

- *Substantial education and training* are *required in order to practice the profession*.
- *The members of the profession themselves decide* the *nature of this training* and more generally, control entry to the profession.
- The profession is *organized into one or more professional bodies*.
- Members of the profession are expected *to conduct their professional activities in accordance with codes of conduct* laid down by the professional bodies and enforced by them.



Pinpoint

While all software engineers are programmers, not all programmers are software engineers.

- The **software engineers** have a broader and more formalized role, requiring professional qualifications, engineering principles, and accountability, especially in critical systems.
- In contrast, **software programmers** primarily focus on writing code without necessarily needing the same level of formal oversight or responsibility for system-wide integrity.



Professional body

A professional body usually **starts by a group of people coming together because of a shared interest in a particular type of activity.**

There are many professional bodies across various fields worldwide including in Sri Lanka. When focusing on the ICT sector, following organizations are considered most relevant.

Global Professional Bodies:

British Computer Society(**BCS**)

Institute of Electrical and Electronical Engineers(**IEEE**)



Professional body...

Sri Lankan Professional Bodies:

- Computer Society of Sri Lanka(**CSSL**)
- Sri Lanka Software Testing Board (**SLSTB**)
- Sri Lanka Association of Software and Service Companies (**SLASSCOM**)
- Federation of Information Technology Industry Sri Lanka (**FITIS**)
- ICT Industry Skills Council (**ICTISC**)



British Computer Society(**BCS**)

BCS a professional body that represents people working in IT, computing, and related fields. It is also known as The Chartered Institute for IT. It Accredits Chartered IT Professional (CITP) and Chartered Engineer (CEng) status.

The BCS Sri Lanka section was established in 1996. The BCS Sri Lanka section has student members, professional members, chartered information technology professionals, and fellow members.



Institute of Electrical and Electronical Engineers(IEEE)

IEEE is the world's largest technical professional organization dedicated to advancing technology for the benefit of humanity. IEEE has a global presence with seven offices internationally.

The IEEE Sri Lanka Section is a global technology organization that promotes technical professionalism and innovation in Sri Lanka. It was established in 2003 and is part of IEEE Region 10.

The section's community includes university academic staff, industry professionals, and undergraduate and graduate students.



Computer Society of Sri Lanka (**CSSL**)

Established in 1976, CSSL is a prominent professional body and learned society for IT professionals in Sri Lanka. It offers various membership grades, including Honorary Fellow Members, Members (MCS), Associate Members, Student Members, and Affiliate Members. CSSL organizes events like the National IT Conference (NITC) and the National Schools' Software Competition (NSSC) to promote ICT knowledge and skills.



Sri Lanka Software Testing Board (**SLSTB**)

Formed in August 2009, SLSTB is the national board representing Sri Lanka within the International Software Testing Qualifications Board (ISTQB). It focuses on nurturing and supporting the software testing profession in Sri Lanka, providing globally accepted qualifications to enhance the skills of software testing professionals.



Sri Lanka Association of Software and Service Companies (SLASSCOM)

SLASSCOM serves as a catalyst for the growth of the Sri Lankan IT and Business Process Management (BPM) industry. It works on developing business opportunities, enhancing education, and increasing employment within the sector.